

ciate rhythm and a good sense of music. Kathak involves reciting beats and having good musical timing. It has drama and grace. I felt Kathak wasn't just about dance. It was the complete package that I liked," says Anna, who completed her 10 years of learning the form last month.

She also takes private classes. Two of her students include the French-born Aurelie Oudiette and Anais Cailleau. While studying for their masters degree in Asian theatre and culture, they decided to

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ISABELLE ANNA,
France

learn an Indian dance form. When they came to Delhi as part of their research work, they saw the movie *Devdas* and fell in love with Kathak. When they went back to France in January 2006, they saw Anna perform there and asked her for help to shift to Delhi. Under her guidance, they moved to the capital and now take classes under her and Pandit Birju Maharaj.

"I have learnt jazz and salsa but felt something was missing. In Kathak, every action has a mean-

IRAVI SATHI

Anna (in front) with her French students Oudiette and Cailleau

